

Poetry Study





About the Course

Students study poetic devices and forms and practice writing poetry themselves.

This topic is included in the following course(s): Poetry: Grade 8



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
8	Poetry Study: Grade 8 1 time/week 20 min	A World of Poetry: Student Book

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Poetry: Grade 8				
Poetry Reading: Grade 8	Poetry Reading: Grade 8	Poetry Reading: Grade 8	Poetry Reading: Grade 8	Poetry Study: Grade 8



Planning & Prep

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LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.

Poetry Study: Grade 8

- ☐ Make sure your student has a notebook for each lesson.
- ☐ Students will be marking their poems and labeling the poems. If you don't want them to mark the books, you will need to make a copy of those pages.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

Poetry Study: Grade 8



A World of Poetry: Student Book



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

Poetry Study: Grade 8

∞ [Answer Key for Poetry Exercises](#)

Click THIS text
or scan the QR
code for links.



Poetry Study: Grade 8

How To Teach



Introduce

Tell something about the poet or the kind of poem or fable to prepare students. Remember that poems are like paintings—they not only convey ideas, they create an experience with the sound of words, the way the words are arranged, and the emotions, thoughts, and images they evoke.



Read

Read the poem aloud in order to hear the sounds and meter. Have students read it aloud as well as it is helpful to hear poetry read by different voices. Try to read paying attention to the punctuation as well as the line breaks to get the sense of the poem.



Discuss

Allow students to share any thoughts or connections. What are your impressions of the poem? Talk about anything that stood out to you: the images, ideas, words, phrases, sounds, or even physical look of the poem. What kinds of things is the poem about?



Reread

Read (or have the student read) the poem again.



Connect

Students may choose to add poems to their Commonplace Book or mark them to copy later.

Poetry Study: Grade 8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 1 20m Poetry Study: Grade 8 - Lesson 1

Materials: A World of Poetry, notebook

→ INTRO

This book will help you understand poetic strategies used by poets and other talented and powerful writers to get their point across. Did you know that Abraham Lincoln wrote poetry as a young man and used poetic techniques in his Gettysburg Address? Poetry may not be ignored; it is a primary form of expression in every society we can recall, and from the beginning of culture. It is a universal and irresistible form of human expression.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.5-14

- Read the line on p.7. Notice the metaphor comparing gravity to a field. We are so used to saying "the field of gravity" that we have forgotten how metaphorical that is. Gravity is only similar to a field in limited ways.
- On p.8, the author says, "Poetry is not just expression in words. It is also expressed in sounds. "In an article written by David Crystal for The Guardian, called "The Ugliest Words", he says, "Here's an experiment. You're in a spaceship approaching a planet. You've been told there are two races on it, one beautiful and friendly to humans, the other unfriendly, ugly, and mean-spirited. You also know that one of these groups is called the Lamonians; the other is called the Grataks. Which is which? Most people assume that the Lamonians are the nice guys. It's all a matter of sound symbolism. Words with soft sounds such as 'l,' 'm,' and 'n,' and long vowels or diphthongs, reinforced by a gentle polysyllabic rhythm, are interpreted as 'nicer' than words with hard sounds such as 'g' and 'k,' short vowels, and an abrupt rhythm."
- Have you thought about how sounds affect the ideas communicated in a poem? Can you think of other examples of how certain sounds make you feel a certain way?

→ DIAGRAM

In your notebook, make a Venn diagram comparing science and poetry.

WEEK 2 20m Poetry Study: Grade 8 - Lesson 2

Materials: A World of Poetry, notebook

→ INTRO

We tend to think that poets get inspiration from something and start writing the first thing that comes to mind, and voila, a poem is made. It is important to remember that poems are planned. Just like an architect plans a building or a composer writes a symphony, a poet uses their mind to assemble components that permit something to be called a poem, including meter, rhyme, vowel sounds, consonant sounds, figures of speech, etc. It is not the undisciplined, spontaneous, and primarily emotional expression it is imagined to be. We will be looking at the sound patterns that make up poetry. What is the pattern? How do we appreciate it visually? Why might we appreciate it aurally (with our ears)?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.18-20

- Find the different patterns in the poem on p.20 and talk about the rhyme scheme.

★ TEACHER TIP

Use the QR codes on the pages in A World of Poetry if you want to hear the poems read aloud.

Poetry Study: Grade 8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

→ WRITE

In your notebook, write down the names and definitions of the patterns in bold on p.18-19.

WEEK 3 20m Poetry Study: Grade 8 - Lesson 3

Materials: A World of Poetry, notebook

→ INTRO

Do you like saying tongue twisters? A famous tongue twister is, "She sells seashells by the seashore". Tongue twisters are fun because most words start with the same sound. We will be learning about that poetic device today.

→ READ & NARRATE

p.22-23

- Go back to the poems on p.22-23 and label the patterns you learned in the previous lesson.

→ WRITE

In your notebook, add alliteration and its meaning to your list of poetic devices.